SecondLook business plan

Prepared: 28 October 2026 · **Launch market:** Greater Toronto Area · **Currency:** Canadian dollars

Planning horizon: the first three full 12-month operating years after commercial launch. A launch date has not been assumed. This is a pre-launch management plan, not a report of historical performance, contracted sales or committed funding.

Executive summary

SecondLook gives people buying a used car “as is” access to a local mechanic over live video. The mechanic guides a visual review and provides a written estimate of the work the vehicle may need to get safety certified. Buyers can add a body shop review and compare several cars before committing.

The proposed launch strategy is to build a trusted GTA referral network through Rodney's automotive relationships, recruit a small pool of qualified providers, and prove the service economics before expanding paid advertising. The user reports that Rodney has deep connections in the GTA car industry. His RTFG Financial website describes Ontario financial services including car loans, and its affiliate page describes an auto-finance offering. These sources support investigating the channel; they do not establish SecondLook partner commitments, buyer volumes or conversion rates. RTFG Financial, partners and affiliates.

The base plan reaches **$46,793 revenue in Year 1, $178,520 in Year 2 and $512,224 in Year 3**, after a 3% refund allowance and before HST. It requires 720, 2,574 and 6,930 paid buying windows respectively. The operating result turns positive in Year 3 at approximately **$20,763**, before corporate tax, depreciation, financing and working-capital timing. These are forecasts driven by explicit assumptions, not evidence of traction.

Plan for approximately **$110,000 of staged launch and operating funding**, subject to provider, insurance and development quotes. The model's annual cash-trough estimate is $91,911 including a $25,000 reserve; $110,000 adds about $18,000 for timing and execution variation. The base case also assumes the founder accepts below-market cash compensation in Years 1-2. Full founder replacement compensation would increase the capital needed.

Customer and problem

The first customer is a GTA buyer considering an older, privately sold or explicitly as-is vehicle who cannot arrange an in-person mechanic visit before the seller moves on. Their question is practical: “What could this cost me beyond the asking price?”

Priority segments are budget-conscious buyers, first-time buyers who want a clear explanation, and finance-assisted buyers who need to understand repair costs alongside the vehicle purchase. These are target segments to validate, not established customer demographics. The service should remain available independently of financing and should not encourage buyers to borrow more than they can afford.

Customer discovery must verify that sellers will participate, buyers accept the limits of video, mechanics can provide a useful estimate remotely, and the written report changes a real purchase decision. A completed booking is more valuable evidence than a mailing-list signup.

Service and pricing

Offer	Buyer price before applicable tax	What it provides
First mechanic inspection	$50	Live review and written estimate for one vehicle
Additional vehicle in the same 14-day window	$25	Another review and report for comparison
Body shop add-on	+$20 per inspection	Additional review of visible body condition

These prices and the 14-day window follow the current pricing requirements. A new purchase episode after the window expires starts again at $50. A paid window is an episode, not a subscription; the model does not assume annual customer retention or repeat subscription revenue. Standalone body-shop bookings are excluded until their offering and economics are settled.

The buyer books, provides vehicle details, arranges the seller's participation, pays and joins a guided call. The report records observed issues, estimated cost ranges and limitations. The product supports comparing vehicles using asking price plus estimated work. Reports must distinguish visible observations from items that require an in-person inspection.

SecondLook's remote assessment does not issue an Ontario Safety Standards Certificate or promise that a vehicle will pass. Ontario describes certificates as following a passed inspection at a licensed Vehicle Inspection Centre. Position SecondLook as help deciding whether to proceed to an in-person inspection or purchase. Ontario certificate information. The government search result was reviewed; direct access to that page returned 403 during research.

Market entry and alternatives

Start with a reachable GTA buyer network rather than a percentage of Canada's entire used-car market. No verified count of GTA as-is transactions or Rodney's qualified buyers was supplied, so this plan does not invent a dollar-valued total addressable market.

The Year 1 reachable-demand assumption is 1,440 qualified partner referrals plus 1,440 direct qualified leads. At assumed conversions of 30% and 20%, those generate 432 partner windows and 288 direct windows. Year 3 requires 14,040 qualified partner referrals and 8,400 direct leads, producing 6,930 paid windows. Those acquisition volumes must be demonstrated before treating the growth curve as credible.

Buyer alternative	Buyer benefit	SecondLook's proposed place
In-person pre-purchase inspection	Physical access, tools and tests unavailable over video	An earlier remote review when access or timing is difficult; escalate when physical examination is needed
Vehicle-history report	Recorded vehicle history	Complement history with a guided look at the current vehicle; neither proves the other complete
Advice from a seller or acquaintance	Easy access and often low cost	A consistent review and written estimate from a qualified independent provider
Buying without a review	No inspection fee or scheduling	Make an informed decision about potential repair exposure before committing

CARFAX Canada's buyer guide recommends pre-purchase inspection; that supports the customer need, not a claim that video replaces physical inspection. CARFAX buyer guide. Its search excerpt was reviewed; direct page access returned 403. Competitor prices, market shares and local transaction volumes have not been verified or used in the forecast.

Rodney-led distribution

Rodney's proposed role is to lead relationship development: make introductions to finance professionals, buyer advisers, appropriate dealerships, mechanics and body shops, and help establish trust with early buyers. His title, time commitment, ownership and compensation remain to be agreed. Nothing in this plan represents an executed partnership with Rodney, RTFG Financial or an affiliate.

The first step is to map approximately 30 warm introductions and qualify 10-15 potential referral businesses. Start with three to five pilot partners; target an annual average of 10 active partners in Year 1, 30 in Year 2 and 65 in Year 3. The last two figures require expansion beyond Rodney's own personal referrals. An active partner should have a trained contact and a repeatable, consent-based referral process. Signed agreements and monthly cohort performance should establish actual productivity and attrition.

Give each partner a short explanation of the service, the 30-second pitch video, a tracked booking link and an example report. The moment of referral is after a buyer identifies a specific vehicle and before committing. Track unique qualified referrals, paid first bookings, completed reviews, refunds, additional cars, report quality and acquisition cost. Deduplicate buyers appearing through multiple partners or channels.

The model budgets a proposed **$5 acquisition fee per served partner window**, not per vehicle, repair job, loan approval or loan size. Payment terms and eligibility require agreement; the model conservatively budgets the cost even where subsequent refunds occur. Rodney's business-development compensation must be agreed within the founder/operations budget or added explicitly; the $5 fee is not also an undisclosed extra founder commission.

Avoid dependence on one distribution source. Track the share of windows coming from Rodney-controlled sources separately from the wider partner network. Once multiple partners are productive, target no individual referral business exceeding 20% of bookings; treat that as a proposed concentration limit, not current performance.

Independence and trust

The buyer is the customer. A referral source must not influence findings, suppress a report, choose an agreeable mechanic or make compensation conditional on the car sale closing. Require conflict declarations where a provider is connected to the seller or referrer, and reassign the review when independence is compromised. Do not include repair or financing commissions in launch economics.

Use explicit consent for sharing contact information and reports. Financing and inspection decisions should stay separate; a SecondLook purchase must not imply financing approval, lender endorsement, certification or guaranteed savings. OMVIC's guidance addresses dealer advertising and as-is disclosures; it is relevant to how participating dealers describe the offer. Obtain professional review of the actual referral arrangements and customer wording before launch. OMVIC advertising guideline.

Delivery and staffing

Launch with scheduled availability across the GTA, including evening and weekend blocks. Verify provider credentials, experience and insurance; use a consistent review checklist, report template, escalation process and customer support owner. Do not promise around-the-clock coverage at launch.

Planning assumptions allow 28 provider minutes for a first mechanic review, 20 for each additional car and 10 incremental body-shop minutes. These include the related review and report work and must be measured in pilot sessions. Assumed payouts are $22, $15 and $12 respectively. Providers have not agreed to these rates.

Capacity driver	Year 1	Year 2	Year 3
Qualified provider roster equivalents	4	10	24
Offered hours per provider per week	5	7	8
Annual weeks	48	48	48
Share of offered time bookable	65%	65%	65%
Bookable provider hours	624	2,184	5,990
Base-case use of bookable hours	76.0%	83.5%	87.9%

Roster equivalents combine the planning time requirement; operational scheduling must separately verify mechanic and body-shop capacity, simultaneous availability and peak-time coverage. The model caps served windows at the calculated capacity, so excess demand does not automatically become revenue. Provider availability does not replace the need for qualified staff in each category.

The current repository is a pre-launch product scaffold with mocks and requirements. Complete and verify booking, payments, identity/access, call coordination, reports, refunds and provider administration before selling the automated service. A tightly managed manual pilot can validate demand and economics while development proceeds, provided its scope and limitations are clear to buyers.

Three-year financial plan

All figures below are annual forecasts, rounded to the nearest dollar. Revenue excludes HST and deducts a 3% refunds/credits allowance. The model assumes SecondLook controls the customer service and records the service price as principal, with providers as delivery costs. An accountant must assess the final contracts; if SecondLook acts as an agent, reported revenue may be only its commission. The figures below are not an agent-revenue forecast.

Measure	Year 1	Year 2	Year 3
Paid buying windows	720	2,574	6,930
Total inspection bookings	1,008	3,861	11,088
Gross service billings	$48,240	$184,041	$528,066
Refunds and credits	($1,447)	($5,521)	($15,842)
Net service revenue	**$46,793**	**$178,520**	**$512,224**
Provider, payment and variable service costs	($26,831)	($103,779)	($301,435)
Gross contribution before acquisition	$19,962	$74,741	$210,789
Partner fees and direct acquisition	($5,616)	($19,998)	($56,826)
Contribution after acquisition	**$14,346**	**$54,743**	**$153,963**
Fixed operating costs	($37,200)	($78,800)	($133,200)
Operating result before tax and D&A	**($22,854)**	**($24,057)**	**$20,763**

Year 3 revenue is about $46.20 per inspection booking, reflecting a mix of $50 first inspections, $25 additional cars and $20 add-ons. It is not $50 multiplied by all inspections. The three-year forecast produces approximately $737,537 in total net service revenue; Year 3 is an annual figure, not a cumulative total.

The operating result is a simplified cash operating proxy. It excludes corporate tax, financing, depreciation/amortization, working-capital changes and full HST remittance timing. It is not net income or a complete cash-flow statement. Payment costs use Stripe's published 2.9% plus CA$0.30 domestic-card price, applied to HST-inclusive charges, with one transaction per inspection. Additional platform/payout fees, cross-border charges and disputes would reduce the result. Stripe Canada. The assumed 13% Ontario HST is excluded from revenue; confirm registration, place of supply and applicable tax treatment. CRA rates.

Unit economics and break-even

At Year 1 assumptions, a $50 mechanic inspection contributes approximately $22.81 after the refund allowance, $22 provider payout, payment costs and $1.75 variable service cost, before acquisition and fixed costs. A $25 additional-car inspection contributes approximately **$6.38** on the same basis. The body-shop add-on contributes approximately $6.74 incrementally, assuming its $12 payout and no separate payment transaction.

The reduced-price inspection is the most fragile part of the offer. A $5 increase in its provider payout cuts its contribution to roughly $1.38. If the pilot cannot deliver the additional inspection at the assumed cost and time, revise the offering through the normal product requirements process before scaling; do not hide the loss in the forecast.

With the modeled annual mix and acquisition spending, contribution per paid window rises from $19.92 to $22.22. Year 3 break-even is approximately **5,996 paid windows per year, or 500 per month**, compared with 6,930 forecast windows. That leaves a modest margin for error. At the Year 1 cost structure, break-even exceeds the small initial roster's capacity; Year 1 is deliberately a funded pilot rather than a self-financing operation.

Demand cases

Case	Year 1 revenue	Year 2 revenue	Year 3 revenue	Year 3 operating result
Downside: 50% of base demand	$23,396	$89,275	$256,112	($56,218)
Base demand	$46,793	$178,520	$512,224	$20,763
Upside: 175% of base demand, capacity capped	$61,551	$213,837	$582,584	$41,911

These cases vary demand while retaining the same pricing, conversion mix, unit costs and fixed budgets. They are not probabilities or best/worst bounds. In the upside case, Year 3 has 4,246 unserved potential windows at the planned provider capacity. Expanding that capacity would require another staffing and overhead plan; the model does not assume those extra sales are fulfilled for free. In the downside case, keeping the full planned overhead creates continuing losses; management should defer expansion rather than spend to the base budget automatically.

Funding and use of cash

Base-case cash requirement	Amount
Pre-launch build, setup, onboarding and assets	$20,000
Year 1 operating deficit	$22,854
Year 2 operating deficit	$24,057
Minimum reserve	$25,000
Annual-trough funding estimate	**$91,911**
Suggested timing / execution headroom	$18,089
Proposed staged funding target	**$110,000**

This is an annual-trough planning estimate, not a verified minimum cash balance. Produce a monthly settlement, payout, tax and seasonality model before taking financing. The downside case would require approximately $182,670 including

the same reserve if all planned annual spending were maintained. It is a reason to stage capital and stop unproductive spending, not an instruction to raise that amount now.

Base founder cash compensation is $12,000, $30,000 and $60,000. Using a $60,000 annual replacement cost adds $48,000 and $30,000 to the first two years' economic cost. Paying that compensation in cash would add $78,000 to base funding needs before any further timing buffer. The plan does not support a full market-rate team in Year 1.

Release an initial approximately $35,000 tranche for the $20,000 launch budget and a controlled pilot. Release the remaining approximately $75,000 only after the pilot demonstrates the demand and cost gates below and the monthly cash plan confirms the runway. Debt service or an equity return has not been assumed. No valuation, ownership split or lender commitment is proposed here.

First 90 days and three-year milestones

Period	Proposed work	Evidence needed to continue
Pre-launch	Confirm Rodney's role; qualify warm introductions; recruit four provider equivalents; obtain legal and insurance quotes; complete booking-to-report pilot	Agreed independence/referral terms, safe customer scope, provider availability and a verified delivery process
Days 1-30 after launch	Activate three to five referral partners and serve approximately 15 paid windows	Buyers and sellers participate; every buyer receives a usable report or an appropriate refund
Days 31-60	Reach approximately 40 cumulative paid windows; test more than one referral source	Measured provider time and payouts support positive unit contribution
Days 61-90	Reach approximately 60 cumulative paid windows; review cohorts and disputes	Credible route toward 30% qualified partner conversion, 3% or lower refund/credit rate, and about $20 contribution per window
Rest of Year 1	Scale quarterly window targets from 60 to 120, 210 and 330, totalling 720	Ten average active partners and 1,008 annual inspection bookings; validate the 40% additional-car assumption
Year 2	Deepen GTA coverage, grow to 30 average active partners, improve scheduling	2,574 paid windows, controlled acquisition cost and sufficient provider coverage
Year 3	Grow to 65 average active partners; expand outside the GTA only after local economics hold	6,930 windows, approximately $512k revenue and positive operating result at planned compensation

The 90-day thresholds are proposed decision gates, not statistically proven rates. Small early cohorts cannot establish rare-event risk or long-term estimate accuracy. Compare remote estimates with later in-person outcomes where buyers consent, investigate material misses, and refine what can reasonably be assessed by video.

Main risks and decisions

Risk	Response and decision
Provider payouts or duration exceed assumptions	Measure each service separately; pause unprofitable offers before expanding
Rodney's introductions do not create repeat paid demand	Track partner cohorts and qualified referrals; continue only where conversions and contribution justify the work
Referral relationships compromise buyer trust	Keep findings independent; disclose conflicts and reassess provider assignment
Video misses a costly or safety-critical defect	Limit claims, record uncertainty, escalate to physical inspection and obtain appropriate insurance
Sellers refuse calls or fail to attend	Confirm seller consent before scheduling; monitor failures and apply clear refund rules
Booking demand exceeds specialist availability	Restrict slots and expand qualified capacity deliberately; do not sell unsupported turnaround promises
Founder time is treated as free forever	Show replacement compensation and set a compensation plan before hiring or funding decisions
Costs are underquoted or liabilities uninsurable	Obtain actual provider, insurance, technology and professional quotes before capital is released

The next commercial decisions are Rodney's agreed involvement, the first named referral cohort, provider rate acceptance, the pilot launch budget and the measurable criteria for releasing the second funding tranche. No outreach, partnership representations or external commitments have been made as part of preparing this plan.

Evidence and review

Product pricing comes from the repository's current requirements. Rodney's network depth comes from the user; his public website supports the financial-services context only. All sales, conversion, volume, attachment, payout, staffing and funding amounts are planning assumptions unless specifically sourced above. Research was reviewed on 28 October 2026. The companion workbook exposes the editable inputs and calculates the same forecast; replace assumptions with observed pilot data and signed quotes each month.

References and companion model

RTFG Financial
https://www.rodneythefinanceguy.ca/

RTFG partners and affiliates
https://www.rodneythefinanceguy.ca/financial-services/partners-affiliates

Ontario Safety Standards Certificate
https://www.ontario.ca/page/safety-standards-certificate

CARFAX Canada used-car buying guide
https://www.carfax.ca/learn/buying/used-car-buying-guide

OMVIC advertising guideline
https://www.omvic.ca/selling/dealer-guidelines-and-resources/advertising-guideline/

Stripe Canada pricing
https://stripe.com/en-ca/pricing

CRA GST/HST rates and place of supply
https://www.canada.ca/en/revenue-agency/services/tax/businesses/topics/gst-hst-businesses/charge-collect-place-supply.html

Companion files: docs/business/revenue-projection.md and outputs/secondlook-business-plan-20261028/secondlook-three-year-projection.xlsx. Source: docs/business/business-plan.md. Financial figures are the base case as of 28 October 2026.